

1467

JAPAN'S WARRING STATES

A dispute over the succession to Japan's ruling shogun triggered fighting in the capital Kyoto between clans led by Yamana Sôzen and Hosokawa Katsumoto. The resulting Onin War was brief, but it fatally weakened the shogunate. With central authority powerless, Japan entered an era of chaotic civil strife between regional warlords, the daimyo.



△ Yamana Sôzen, known as the Red Monk

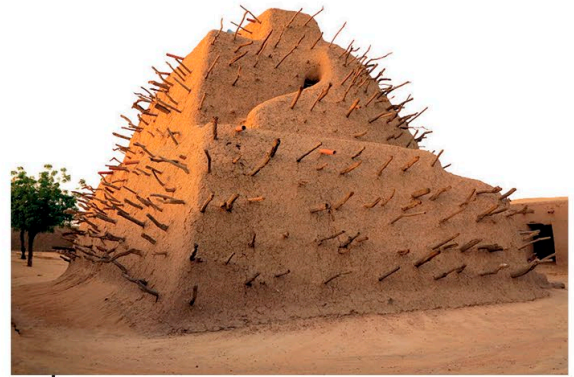
1461 French poet
François Villon writes
his famous work *Le Testament*

1460

1468

SONNI ALI TAKES TIMBUKTU

In the 15th century, the West African Mali Empire went into decline. Sonni Ali, leader of the Songhai people, seized the opportunity to capture the Malian cities of Timbuktu and Djenné. At his death in 1492, Sonni's Songhai Empire was more extensive than Mali had ever been. It lasted for a century.



△ Mud tomb of Askia, second ruler of the Songhai Empire

1471 The Champa kingdom
in southern Vietnam is crushed
by Dai Viet in the Cham-
Vietnamese War

Under the Ming, the
Great Wall extended over
8,850 km (5,500 miles)

1472

MING EXTEND THE GREAT WALL

After a disastrous defeat by Mongol Oirats at the Battle of Tumu in 1449, Ming China felt increasingly menaced by incursions of nomadic warriors along its steppe border. In 1472, work began on extending the ancient Great Wall frontier defences in the north-western Ordos region. The success of the Ordos Wall in stopping raiders led the Ming to continue additions and repairs to the Wall.



△ Section of the Great Wall of China rebuilt under the Ming